

Question 60 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate two alternative training programs for the same organisational need using the Kirkpatrick model and recommend the more effective program.

Introduction

Evaluation using Kirkpatrick means judging each alternative at reaction, learning, behaviour and results, then recommending. Need used here: first-line supervisors must learn to give developmental feedback (this supports HRD climate and appraisal as a development tool). Programme A is glamorous but shallow. Programme B is TNA-based and blended. You may change the need, but you must compare two programmes level by level and give a clear recommendation.

Detailed points

- 1. Programme A described.** Two-day off-site ‘leadership’ with a famous motivational speaker, luxury venue, little practice of feedback skill, no involvement of the supervisors’ own bosses, no follow-up, no change in appraisal forms. Marketing looks excellent.
- 2. Programme B described.** Built from TNA: short concept module on what developmental feedback is; extensive role play with checklists; real feedback assignments on the job; the supervisors’ bosses act as coaches; 60-day follow-up workshop; an appraisal item on coaching quality. Venue is ordinary.
- 3. Level 1 — Reaction.** A will often score higher: travel, celebrity, food. B will score adequately if participants see job relevance, but some may say it was ‘hard work’. If the organisation judged only level 1, it would wrongly buy A.
- 4. Level 2 — Learning.** B is superior because people practise the actual skill and get feedback. A may give memorable quotes without the ability to hold a feedback conversation. Tests and role-play scores would show this if anyone measured them.
- 5. Level 3 — Behaviour.** B is far superior: assignments, job aids, and boss support. A rarely transfers; the old habit of only scolding or only silence returns. Climate of the supervisors’ own workplace decides A’s failure.
- 6. Level 4 — Results.** B is more likely to improve employee development climate, earlier correction of errors, and engagement in the supervisors’ teams. A is costly with little organisational result. Level 4 is why the company should care.
- 7. Recommendation.** Recommend Programme B even if smile sheets are slightly lower. Effectiveness in HRD is behaviour and results in the service of the organisational need, not applause. State the condition: B still fails at level 3 if top management does not support coaching time — so the recommendation includes that support.
- 8. What this evaluation teaches.** Kirkpatrick protects the organisation from buying the more popular but less effective programme. Write this meta-point; it shows you can use the model, not only recite it.

Conclusion. Compare A and B at all four Kirkpatrick levels. Recommend the TNA-based blended Programme B because it can reach learning, behaviour and results, while A mainly maximises reaction. Effectiveness is not the same as popularity. Condition: workplace support must accompany B.